pregnancy and preschool children receive 20 mg elemental iron+ 100 mcg folic acid daily. To improve compliance, ensuring availability to all beneficiaries, follow up of pregnant women through ante natal care (ANC) for completion of therapy, counseling on common side effects, risks associated with anaemia, provision of incentives to frontline workforce, frequent evaluation to assess the programme, weekly or biweekly administration of iron and folate and inclusion of adolescent as beneficiaries are needed.

3. **National Iron$^+$ Initiative:** Taking cognizance of ground realities in the operation of the programme, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare took a policy decision to develop the National Iron$^+$ Initiative. This initiative will bring together existing programmes (IFA supplementation for pregnant and lactating women and children in the age group of 6-60 months). Thus National Iron$^+$ Initiative will reach the following age groups for supplementation :



Fig 12.2: National Iron$^+$ Initiative

- Biweekly iron supplementation for preschool children of 6 months to 5 years.
- Weekly supplementation for children from 1st to 5th grade in Government and Government aided schools.
- Weekly supplementation for school children (5-10 years) at anganwadi centres.
- Pregnant and lactating women, daily for 100 days.
- Weekly supplementation for women in reproductive age group.

In addition to increased iron and folate intake, improvement in environmental sanitation and personal hygiene are also needed to control worm infestations and infections. Deworming done regularly would help in reducing the incidence of anaemia and improve the efficacy of iron supplements. An improvement in food intake results in improvement in haemoglobin levels.

ACTIVITY

7. Find out the name of the medicine given for deworming in your school every 6 months.
8. How frequently are iron tablets given? Find out its composition.

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